accepting as fully satisfactory, the interpretation of causality indicated above. For even if it should prove to be feasible to develop further the concept of causality along the lines described, the concept as here proposed involved a serious flaw. For it could be maintained that a relation possessing such profound significance as the causal connection between two successive events represents ought to be independent by its very nature from the human intellect which is considering it. Instead, we have not only linked at the very outset the concept of causality to the human intellect, specifically to the ability of man to predict an occurrence; but we have been able to carry through the deterministic viewpoint only with the expedient of replacing the directly given sense world by the world picture of physics, that is, by a provisional and alterable creation of the human power of imagination. These are anthropomorphic traits which ill-befit fundamental concepts of physics; and the question therefore arises whether it is not possible to give the concept of causality a deeper meaning by divesting it as far as it can be of its anthropomorphic character, and to make it independent of human artifacts such as the world picture of physics. Of course, we shall have to adhere to our basic premise, that an occurrence is causally determined if it can be predicted with a certainty, for otherwise we would lose the only solid foundation for our discussion. And we must feel bound to no less a degree to our second principle, that it is never possible, to predict an occurrence with absolute precision. It accordingly follows that if we are to speak at all of causality in nature, we must introduce some modification into our first basic proposition. To this extent the situation remains as it was before. But the type of modification which we introduced previously into the first basic proposition can be replaced by a totally different one.

In the preceding discussion what was modified was the object of the prediction—the occurrence. For we related the occurrences not to the directly given sense world, but to an artificially created world picture, and we thus found it possible to determine occurrences accurately. But instead of modifying the object of predictions we can alter our notion of the subject of the prediction, that is, of the predicting intellect. For every prediction presupposes somebody who does the predicting. Therefore, in the following discussion we shall direct our attention solely to the predicting subject, and shall consider as the objects of prediction the directly given occurrences of the sense world, without introducing an artificial world picture.

First of all, it is easy to see that the reliability of a prediction depends, to a high degree, on the individual personality of the one who is making it. If we consider again weather forecasts, it makes a great difference whether tomorrow’s weather is forecast by an amateur who knows nothing about today’s atmospheric pressure, wind direction, atmospheric temperature and humidity, or by a capable farmer who considers all these data and also has a